Q17 Understanding Check

Question. A report says an MoE model is "sparse." Give two distinct meanings of sparsity that this could be confused with, and state how they differ.

Expected answer. MoE has sparse expert activation: only some feed-forward experts run for a token. Sparse attention instead limits token-position connections. Quantization is not either one; it changes numeric precision.

Diagnoses conflation of routing, attention connectivity, and numerical compression.